



THE COMPLETE GUIDE

Medication Mail-Back Kit Guide

DEA-authorized mail-back for unused medication — what's allowed, who can use it, and how the documentation works.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Unused meds, gone for good.

A medication mail-back kit is the simplest DEA-authorized way to collect and destroy unused medication — including controlled substances — without a truck, a take-back event, or a drug-diversion risk sitting in a drawer. Pharmacies, long-term care, clinics, and households all use them. This guide explains what a mail-back kit can and can't take, who is authorized to offer collection, how controlled substances are handled, and what documentation you get back.

The good news

One kit legally collects both controlled and non-controlled medication together — no sorting by schedule at the point of collection, and non-retrievable destruction is handled for you.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
DEA	Secure and Responsible Drug Disposal Act & 21 CFR 1317 — authorized collectors, mail-back packages, and non-retrievable destruction.
EPA	Where returned medication is RCRA-hazardous, hazardous-waste handling applies.
DOT	Compliant mail-back packaging for shipment through the mail.
State	State rules on who may operate collection receptacles and mail-back programs.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

What the kit collects

A DEA mail-back package can take the widest range of household and facility medication in one container.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Controlled & non-controlled medications together
- Tablets, capsules, patches
- Liquids in original containers (per program)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps & needles (own kit)
- Inhalers/aerosols & illicit substances
- Chemo/hazardous drugs (own path)

THE RULE · DEA — an authorized mail-back package may collect controlled and non-controlled medication together for non-retrievable destruction.

DISPOSE WITH · Seal the inner liner, mail the prepaid package, and we render the contents non-retrievable.

Tip

Keep medications in the mail-back liner only — don't add sharps, which need their own container.

WASTE STREAM 02

Who can use it

Mail-back kits serve both institutions and the public.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Pharmacies & LTC facilities (authorized collectors)
- Clinics offering patient take-back
- Households disposing of personal medication

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Anyone using it for illicit-drug disposal
- Facilities substituting it for required inventory destruction records

THE RULE · DEA — retail pharmacies, hospitals/clinics with an on-site pharmacy, and LTC facilities can be authorized collectors; individuals can use household mail-back.

DISPOSE WITH · Match the program to your role — collector program vs. single-household kit.

Tip

Long-term care has specific DEA provisions for disposing of a resident's medication — a mail-back program fits cleanly.

WASTE STREAM 03

Documentation & destruction

The kit closes the loop with proof, not just a bin.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Non-retrievable destruction of contents
- A Certificate of Destruction
- Tracking on the return package

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Any expectation to inventory individual household contents
- Reselling or reusing collected medication

THE RULE · DEA non-retrievable standard — collected medication is permanently destroyed; collectors may not inventory individual contents of a sealed liner.

DISPOSE WITH · Non-retrievable destruction with documentation returned to the account.

Tip

For facilities, keep the Certificate of Destruction — it's your proof the program is closing the loop compliantly.

YOUR CHECKLIST

Your medication mail-back checklist.

- ☐ The right program for your role — collector vs. household kit
- ☐ Controlled and non-controlled medication collected in one liner
- ☐ Sharps and hazardous/chemo drugs routed to their own streams
- ☐ Mail-back packaging kept DEA- and DOT-compliant
- ☐ Sealed liners never opened or inventoried at the item level
- ☐ Non-retrievable destruction confirmed by Certificate of Destruction
- ☐ LTC resident-medication disposal handled under DEA provisions

QUESTIONS ABOUT MEDICATION MAIL-BACK KITS

Medication mail-back FAQ.

Can a mail-back kit take controlled substances?

Yes. A DEA-authorized mail-back package is designed to collect controlled and non-controlled medication together and render it non-retrievable — that's the whole point of the DEA program.

Who is allowed to offer a mail-back collection program?

Retail pharmacies, hospitals and clinics with an on-site pharmacy, and long-term care facilities can register as authorized collectors. Individuals can use household mail-back kits for their own medication.

What can't go in the kit?

Sharps and needles (they need a sharps container), inhalers and aerosols, illicit substances, and chemotherapy or other hazardous drugs, which follow the RCRA-hazardous path.

Do I have to sort the medication by schedule?

No. That's the advantage — controlled and non-controlled medication go into the same sealed liner, and the destruction handles the rest. Collectors are not permitted to inventory the individual contents of a sealed liner.

What do I get back as proof?

A Certificate of Destruction confirming the contents were rendered non-retrievable — your documentation that the program closed the loop compliantly.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Offer patients or residents a DEA-authorized mail-back kit, or use one for your own facility's unused medication. Controlled and non-controlled drugs go in one sealed liner, the prepaid package ships through the mail, and we render the contents non-retrievable and return a Certificate of Destruction.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Unused controlled & non-controlled meds	Medication mail-back kit
Sharps & needles	Sharps kit
Chemo/hazardous drugs	RCRA-hazardous kit
Facility inventory destruction	Controlled-substance destruction + Form 41

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Running a collector program across multiple pharmacies or LTC sites? We supply, track, and document mail-back kits at scale — ask for a quote.



WHY PHARMACIES & FACILITIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your medication waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop